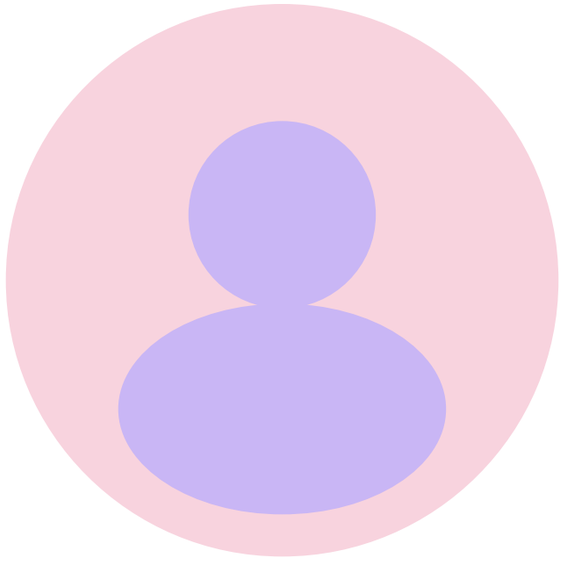
Ihor Petrenko



AGE 54

OCCUPATION Math Lecturer

LOCATION Lviv, Ukraine

> “ I explain a topic once in class. I need to know who actually understood it.

Bio

Ihor is an associate professor at the Department of Higher Mathematics of Lviv Polytechnic. Every semester he gives lectures to a stream of six first-year groups, about 150 students. He has been teaching for more than 25 years and does not like complicated software: he uploads PDF problem sets to the current VNS and announces everything else in class. Formulas cannot be written properly in messengers, so students send him photos of their solutions late at night. He wants first-year students to keep up from the first weeks, not to discover their gaps only at the exam.

Goals

- Help first-year students keep up with the course from the first weeks
- Reach the whole stream of six groups with a single announcement
- Check how well students understand each topic without spending evenings grading

Core needs

- A simple interface that can be used without training or long instructions
- Course discussions with proper formula support, so math questions stay in the course
- Self-check tests generated from his problem sets, with results for each topic
- Announcements and schedule changes for all his groups at once, with read confirmation
- A clear picture of which topics the stream understands poorly before the exam

Frustrations

- New tools are often complicated, and he has no time to learn them
- Students send photos of solutions in messengers at night, and formulas are hard to discuss there
- He finds out that most of the stream did not understand a topic only at the midterm test
- To announce a room change he has to ask the head of each group separately
- With 150 students it is impossible to give individual feedback to everyone